AUSTRALASIAN RECORD

"Sound an alarm: for the day of the Lord cometh, for it is nigh at hand."

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The Hidden Way

We may not know, we cannot see
  Just what Thou hast for us before.
But while we trusting lean on Thee,
  Tis good alone Thou hast in store.
So, hidden though the pathway be,
  We'll walk by faith, dear Lord, in Thee.

In trials deep, afflictions sore,
  When called to walk, 'tis not alone—
Jesus has trod this way before,
  His Spirit leads till night is gone;
And in the home of endless love,
  When pain is past, we'll reign above.

Who would not like the Master be?
  The meek and lowly, loving One
Who bore the trials man must see
  And conquered, He the sinless Son.
Then bear the cross as He did bear,
  And thou a crown with Him shalt wear.

In love and faith take up the load
  Permitted by our Friend divine,
And strength will come to walk the road
  That upward leads; so ne'er repine.
Recall to mind each step is known
  E'en now to God upon His throne.

W. R. C.

A Matter of Great Moment

ONE of the most important qualifications of the true Christian is frequently given the least attention by those who are confidently expecting the Christian's reward.

God has told us very specifically some of the most important characteristics of those who shall be accounted worthy to inhabit the palaces of eternity. We read:

"Lord, who shall sojourn in Thy tabernacle? Who shall dwell in Thy holy hill? He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness, and speaketh truth in his heart. He that slandereth not with his tongue, nor doeth evil to his friend, nor taketh up a reproach against his neighbour." Ps. 15:1-3.

Three times in this short scripture, inspiration makes reference to the work of the tongue. The redeemed soul will speak truth, he will not slander "with his tongue," and he will not take up "a reproach against his neighbour." But if probation should close to-day, how many of us who profess the name of Christ would be able to pass that qualification test? It is a standard that few measure up to. The natural tendency is all the other way. If the course of a brother or a sister does not meet with our approval, our first inclination is to talk the matter over with some one else. But that is not what God expects us to do. "Go and tell him his fault between thee and him alone." What gossip-killers Christians would be if they would arm themselves with that weapon and use it unflinchingly! And wherever gossip is killed, souls are saved.

We cannot overestimate the importance of that instruction, and the importance of coming up to the Christian qualification test above mentioned. All that heaven has for us depends upon how we relate ourselves to this matter; for we read again: "Death and life are in the power of the tongue." Prov. 18:21. And that, too, has a double-edged application; for it means death or life not only to us, but also to those who may be affected by our doings or may follow our course—upward, if it be upward; or downward, if it be downward.

The Psalmist sets before us an ideal purpose in regard to this matter: "I will take heed to my ways, that I sin not with my tongue: I will keep my mouth with a bridle, while the wicked is before me." Ps. 39:1. This is an expression of the purpose of Christ. He would not take up a reproach, even against the wicked. Many of us feel that because we do not transgress the commandments by overt acts, we can pass judgment upon everybody and everything, and be perfectly guiltless. The Word of God gives us no warrant for any such hope; its admonitions are all against it. There is perhaps no more expressive form of that admonition than this: "I will keep my mouth with a bridle." He would not give it a free rein. He would not permit Himself to canvass the shortcomings of His associates. He would not take up a railing accusation against even Satan himself, but left him for God to deal with. And what was not safe for Christ to do is not safe for us to do.

Many of the admonitions of Scripture in reference to this matter apply to our experiences both in this life and in the life to come. In Prov. 21:23 we find this one: "Whoso keepeth his mouth and his tongue keepeth his soul from troubles." That is as true here as hereafter; and so is this one: "He that would love life, and see good days, let him refrain his tongue from evil, and his lips that they speak no guile."

1 Peter 3 : 10. He who refuses to heed that admonition will have no place among the one hundred and forty-four thousand; for "in their mouth was found no guile." They will have learned, before probation closes, to control their tongues.

When sin and sinners have been burned out of the earth, and God has set up His kingdom here, it is written that "they shall not hurt nor destroy in all My holy mountain." Isa. 11 : 9. That rules out the gossiper and the talebearer; for we read that "the words of a talebearer are as wounds." Prov. 18 : 8. "Where there is no talebearer, the strife ceaseth." Prov. 26 : 20. If God should take into His kingdom those who had not overcome the tendency to gossip and criticize, the peace of His universe would be broken again. Every talebearer taken into the kingdom would be another "accuser of the brethren," and the great conflict between sin and righteousness would have to be fought out again.

Perfection in the sight of God must be the aim of every true Christian. He will not expect to reach it by his own powers or goodness; but that must be his aim. "Ye therefore shall be perfect, as your Heavenly Father is perfect." Matt. 5 : 48. "Not that I have already obtained, or am already made perfect: but I press on," etc. Phil. 3 : 12. What is the test of perfection?—"If any stumbleth not in word, the same is a perfect man, able to bridle the whole body also." James 3 : 2. Perfection is prerequisite of salvation; but a tongue under control is prerequisite of perfection. It is therefore one of the first requisites of salvation. That being the case, is it not surprising that so little consideration is given to a matter upon which so much depends?

James further admonishes us: "Speak not one against another, brethren. He that speaketh against a brother, or judgeth his brother, speaketh against the law, and judgeth the law: but if thou judgest the law, thou art not a doer of the law, but a judge. One only is the Lawgiver and Judge, even He who is able to save and to destroy: but who art thou that judgest thy neighbour?" James 4 : 11, 12. We had not supposed, when we were criticizing one another and judging one another, that we were putting ourselves in the place of God, usurping His prerogatives; but that is the way inspiration puts it. While we have been condemning the Papacy for putting itself in the place of God and usurping His prerogatives, we have been, in principle, doing the same thing whenever we have yielded to the temptation to sit in judgment on our brethren, "speaking one against another."

This is no light matter. The destiny of our own souls is dependent upon how we relate ourselves to the matter of controlling our tongues. Verily, "death and life are in the power of the tongue." If we would choose life, we must control the tongue. We must cease from our lingual activities in the line of criticizing one another and flaunting the faults and failures of one another before others. "To him therefore that knoweth to do good, and doeth it not, to him it is sin." James 4 : 17. On the other hand, "the fruit of righteousness is sown in peace for them that make peace." James 3 : 18. Let us be like the worthy woman of the Proverbs who "openeth her mouth with wisdom"; and in whose tongue is "the law of kindness." In doing so, we not only remove the barriers that stand between ourselves and salvation, but we also remove, by our example, barriers that would prevent the salvation of others.

C. M. Snow.

"Our sin has been compared to a spark, and God's forgiving love to an ocean. Who would doubt that the ocean could quench the spark? Our sin has been of short growth. God's goodness wells up from all eternity."

"A mother sought the pardon of her son from the first Napoleon. The emperor said it was his second offence, and justice demanded his death. 'I don't ask for justice,' said the mother, 'I plead for mercy.' 'But,' said the emperor, 'he does not deserve mercy.' 'Sire,' cried the mother, 'it would not be mercy if he deserved it, and mercy is all I ask for.' 'Well, then,' said Napoleon, 'I will have mercy.' And her son was saved. It is only by the exercise of His great mercy—treating us better than we deserve—that God can save us."

WORLD-WIDE

A Good Word from England

The following encouraging items are from a letter (dated end of 1913) from Pastor S. G. Haughey, president of the South England Conference:

"We have been having some good experiences in the South England Conference this year. I began an effort in Plymouth in October of last year, and for five and one-half months continued the meetings without a break. We have now added forty-nine to that church. Our late brother, Pastor W. A. Shafer, held a similar effort in Bristol, and added between forty and fifty to the church there. Our Sabbath school offerings were more last quarter than they have been for any quarter during the years of the past. All our offerings to missions amount to more for the three quarters of this year than for the entire year of 1912. Our tithe was £200 more for the first nine months of this year than it was for the corresponding period of 1912. We feel grateful for the Lord's continued blessing upon us."

The Work in Italy

It has been my privilege during the past year to baptize thirteen new believers in this land of the Papacy. One has been received by letter, making fourteen members gained this past year.

It was a blessed occasion last week in Pisa when we saw over ten thousand persons gathered on the bank of Arno River to witness a baptismal service. Among them were many priests. While I was baptizing, Brother Lippolis spoke to that large gathering from a boat, concerning our work. It was a splendid afternoon, and we were glad to witness for God to such a large audience.

The week before, a scene something like this took place on the bank of the same Arno River in Florence, where a French teacher of languages in an international school of languages in Florence, was baptized.

I have encouraging reports from

our workers in Naples, Gravina, Genoa, and other places. Our courage is as good as ever. We ask you to remember the work and the workers in Italy in your prayers. L. ZECHETTO.

A Missionary Campaign in Battle Creek, Michigan

A FEW weeks ago one of the ministers of this city spoke to his congregation on the Sabbath question. He made the usual arguments against Sabbath observance, such as the round-earth theory and the expediency of one rest day. The sermon was published in a daily paper, and some of our brethren felt that this was an opportune time to give the people something on the Sabbath question. A committee was appointed to determine what should be done.

We finally decided upon a tract campaign, and plans were laid to get the four best tracts on this subject, place them in an envelope, and leave one such package at every home in the city. This work was turned over to the missionary volunteer society, and about six thousand of each of the four tracts were ordered. These were more than paid for by a collection that was taken when the master was presented to our church.

Each tract was stamped with the following note: "Should you desire other reading matter on this or other religious topics, address Missionary Volunteers, Tabernacle, Battle Creek, Michigan." A call was made for volunteers to stamp and place the twenty-four thousand tracts in envelopes, and two evenings were pleasantly spent in this work. The young people worked earnestly and faithfully. After the task was finished, all united in asking the Lord's blessing upon the literature, and in praying that many souls might be brought into the light through the perusal of the tracts.

The city was divided into districts, and a director selected to take charge of the work in each district. On the appointed day all who were to take part in this tract distribution gathered in the Tabernacle to talk over plans and ask God's special blessing. In about three hours all the leaflets were scattered, "like the leaves of autumn."

Although we may not see the results of our work here, yet we rejoice in the fact that if we are faithful in the sowing, the Lord will take care of the harvest. We are trusting Him to prosper our feeble efforts. D. O. B.

MISSIONS

I Know Not, Lord

I know not, Lord, how dark the night
Through which my feet may grope;
But this I know, Thou art my light,
Thy Word my only hope.

I know not, Lord, the devious paths
O'er which my way may tend;
But this I know, Thy Word is sure,
Thou'lt keep me to the end.

I know not, Lord, what I can do
To haste this message sweet;
But Lord, I consecrate my all,
And rest in Thee, complete.

And then whate'er Thou hast for me
Of changes, I'll abide,
In storm or calm, in shade or sun,
Safe sheltered by Thy side.

And when the sheaves are garnered in,
And Thou, my Lord, dost come,
May I be numbered with the blest
Who hear the glad "Well done."

—*Selected.*

Suva, Fiji

A Good Testimony

ON the fifteenth of January I boarded a steamer in Lau to come to the Government Hospital, Suva. On the way over I landed at a place called Vuna and spent a few days, during which time I preached twice, and conducted a number of studies, and other small meetings. Three persons fully decided to connect with this church and commenced to keep the Sabbath. Others believed what was said and were left considering the matter.

Two days after reaching Suva I entered the hospital and was operated upon. When the people there saw the clean, healthy condition of my blood, they were surprised, and commenced to ask who was this man. On learning that I was a minister of the Adventist Church, their curiosity was increased. As I lay there recovering from the operation, and reading the three books I had with me, the Bible, "Bible Doctrines," and "Early Writings," they continued to come to ask me concerning portions of Scripture, and the doctrines and practices of the Adventist Church. Several admitted that this was a clean, true church. Some were continually borrowing my books to take away to read, and when bringing them back would ask more questions.

My restoration to usual health was quick, but my stay there was one long sermon, and time well spent. I am now well again.

PAULIASI BUNOA.

The Arrival of a Missionary

AS WE are a people with the burden resting upon us of giving the inhabitants of the South Sea Islands the last warning message for this time, we are necessarily a people greatly interested in missions and missionaries.

Most of those in the homeland have seen the departure of a missionary for foreign shores; but only those who are, or have been, resident in the mission fields, know the joy of meeting a new worker. This has lately been our pleasure.

Having received a cablegram on Monday, stating than Miss Clarke was leaving Sydney by a certain boat, my husband and I prepared to take a trip to Suva on Tuesday to meet our new matron for the girls' home.

Now, at this time of the year, when hurricanes are likely to sweep down upon us, it is not considered safe to do much sea travelling in a small boat, especially when one has to cross about twenty-five miles of open sea in passing from one island to another, as we have to do when we leave Buresala to go to Suva.

The night previous to our leaving was very stormy, with heavy rain and thunder—in fact, it was so boisterous that we were awakened several times from our sleep, and once Mr. White asked, "What's this,—a hurricane?"

However, when we arose at 4.30 a.m. the wind had dropped, and the morning seemed calm; but ere we left the safety of our little island home, we asked Him who holds the waters in the hollow of His hand to protect us as we travelled o'er them, and that He who had stilled the tempest of Galilee would again command, "Peace be still."

We left Buresala just a few minutes before 6 a.m. and took our course out to the island of Moturiki, and then along in lea of its shores till we left its shelter behind, and crossed the open sea to the mouth of the Rewa River of Viti Levu.

As this is a delta river it affords a fine passage for small boats plying between this island and Suva, as the

boats can enter one mouth of the river and go out by the other which enters the sea just a short distance from Suva.

Thus far, although there was some swell on the water, we had a splendid trip with a favourable breeze, for which we were thankful. When we left the river and entered the sea again, we noticed a heavy tropical shower coming, and thence on, till we reached Suva, we had heavy rain.

On our arrival at Suva we found that all the shopkeepers were expecting a hurricane, and they had prepared for it by barricading their plate-glass windows with full length heavy timber shutters.

We were glad to see Pastor and Sister Stewart back at Suva Vou, having returned from their trip to Tonga and Samoa just a few days previous to our arrival. Brother and Sister Stewart told us that they had experienced a very heavy thunderstorm during the previous night. In fact, so close did the storm appear that the thunder claps seemed to break over their very house. We were indeed thankful to God for our safe passage.

Upon inquiry, we found that the steamer *Levuka*, by which Miss Clarke was travelling, was to arrive on Thursday, but it was one o'clock, Friday morning, before the steamer dropped anchor at the Suva wharf. Before breakfast that morning Brother Stewart and my husband drove to Suva to meet Miss Clarke. When they returned we all sat down to breakfast together. It is indeed a pleasure to welcome some one from the homeland, and we are glad to have Miss Clarke with us, for she is much needed in our work for the girls.

We expected that we would all be able to return to Buresala on the following Sunday, but when we returned to Suva that day for Miss Clarke's luggage, we found, owing to fresh cases of smallpox being reported in Sydney, that every passenger had to report to the health officer daily for one week. This necessitated Miss Clarke's staying at Suva Vou.

On the Sunday we returned to Buresala, bringing Pastor Stewart with us. He spent a few days here in the interests of the work. Then he crossed the sea again to reach Viti Levu and to visit the school at Namarai, Brother and Sister Butler going with him.

From Namarai the little company of travellers went direct to Suva Vou, a journey of nine or ten hours in the launch.

About 5.30 p.m. on Tuesday, just a fortnight after we had set out to meet Miss Clarke, we heard the faint sound of the *davui*, or shell trumpet, coming across the waters, and immediately the cry rang out from the boys' home, "Sail O!"

We went to the beach, where the young men were already, and the girls soon came. I think by the look of the students that after the cry of "Sail O!" went forth, there must have been a hurrying for best *sulus* and coats among the boys, and best pinafores among the girls. After all, human flesh is a good deal alike, and most of us wish to make good "first impressions."

As those who had come left the launch in a small boat to come ashore, the students sang several hymns of welcome. The girls had filed up in one long line, and looked, as Miss Clarke afterwards remarked, as if they were saying, "You see we can be prim and proper if we like."

We think they were all glad to see their new mistress, as are we all. We pray that God will bless Miss Clarke and make her a blessing to those for whose sake she has come to Fiji.

MABEL V. WHITE.

Atchin, New Hebrides

THE past month has been a very busy one with us, and we trust that it has been profitable for the work here. Every week sees some additions to the improvements already made on the place.

School has been held four mornings each week; and services on Wednesday and Friday nights and three times each Sabbath. The attendance has varied but little, and we are much encouraged with our start. The only drawback is the lack of a means for calling the natives to meeting. If this were met it would greatly increase the present attendance, and make those who do come more regular. Yet we cannot complain, as it is a wonder that they attend at all, for they are in the darkest state of heathenism. We have given on an average twelve treatments a day, besides visiting every afternoon among the sick and others.

A nice little dinghy has been given to the mission by Mr. Farrell, the trader, who had to leave this place in order to save his life. It will be just what we need in connection with the boat which our Sabbath-schools are giving to this mission. How the Lord does provide! In His service the UNEXPECTED is always taking place. We are thankful that we serve such a God, whose arm is so long that it reaches down into every little detail of life.

Our lot seems to be cast amongst some of the unpleasant scenes of life; but this must be best for us and for the work of the Lord here. We ask not to be removed from them, but that God will give us grace to bear them, and strength to carry His work triumphantly through them. In the past we have tasted a little of Paul's experience found in 2 Cor. 11:24-28. Now we are having a little taste of his experience of perils amongst the heathen. If only we can say at the finish, as he said, "I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith," we shall consider these perils but roses strewn along our path to make our offering more fragrant to our dear Master who has done so much for us.

Sunday, February 22, was a sad day for the Presbyterian Mission in this district. Just a few miles from our mission, seven of their native teachers were shot down, roasted, and eaten. The following Wednesday the missionary who has charge of this district came and removed his two native teachers, telling me that he did not consider it safe for them to remain, as there was a plot to kill every one that wore calico, and that the Atchin people were the cause of it.

We are now left alone with this people. We could not leave if we wanted to do so, as we have no boat by which to take passage. There is no communication between the natives of this island and Wala and Rano, as the people of those islands have vowed that they will shoot a man of Atchin. We have no fears, our trust is in One who holds the universe in His hands, and all things must obey His commands. These stormy winds and angry waves of human passion which have arisen, will sink to silence at His command, "Peace, be still."

All we need is your prayers that our eyes shall be kept upon Jesus, so that we shall not doubt, as Peter did, and soon our boat will be at the "other side." 2 Cor. 2:14.

C. H. AND M. PARKER.

My Prayer

Not that there be less to bear,
Not that there be more to share,
But for braver heart for bearing,
But for freer heart for sharing,
Here I pray.

Not for scenes of richer beauty,
Not for paths of lighter duty,
But for clearer eyes for seeing,
Gentler hands, more patient being,
Every day.

Not that joy and peace enfold me,
Not that wealth and pleasure hold me,
But that I may dry a tear,
Speak a word of strength and cheer
On the way.

—*Selected.*

Kerang, Victoria

AFTER our late conference in Victoria, it was decided that the writer, assisted by Brother Burgess, should locate at Kerang, where Sister M. McDowell had been doing Bible work for five months. This town is situated near the Murray, in the dry regions of the northern part of Victoria. It has a population of from two to three thousand people. Since irrigation has been carried on it is a prosperous town, as is shown by the money and time squandered on pleasure.

We had so little difficulty in finding a place to erect our tent that we thought we were among an interested people, but when our meetings commenced, found it otherwise. One minister scattered Canright's writings and preached against us; this and other influences had brought such a prejudiced condition, that the few who came to our meetings seemed unable to change their minds in regard to the truth. Our mission opened on Sunday, January 18, with an attendance of twenty, and we had from two to ten during the week. This continued until the testing truths were presented, then there was a decrease. Every home in the town has been visited and well supplied with literature. Many recognize that they have heard Bible truths, but the fear of man and the desire for things of this life seem of more value than the things of God.

Though the distance from farm to farm is very great in places, we are trying to visit all, and hope to find some precious souls willing to respond to the call of God to come out of Babylon. As this is the largest town north of Bendigo, it has two good bi-weekly papers that have a circulation in all the small towns around. We advertised in both papers and have been greatly helped by the insertion of honest reports of our meetings. The editor of one paper requested me to write two articles, one on "Labour and Capital," the other on the "War Question." These have pleased him very much. Thus nearly three thousand people have heard some points of the message. A few are weighing the truth placed before them, but it grieves us much to see so many choosing the transitory pleasures and riches of this earth rather than the eternal joy and wealth of the earth made new.

JOSEPH E. STEED.

Camp-Meeting in the West

THE camp-meeting held at Perth, West Australia, was the closing meeting for this season. West Australia is distant about twelve hundred miles from Adelaide. As a country it has many advantages. Its climate is fresh and even, especially in the inland cities. Its population is just over 300,000. Timber to the value of £1,000,000 was exported last year, and its gold production for the same period amounted to 1,314,000 ounces. Grain was sown on 300,000 acres with a prospective yield of 14,000,000 bushels. In its fruit orchards there are 19,000 acres under cultivation.

The location chosen for the meeting was a park, kindly granted for the purpose by the Perth City Council. It was located about three miles to the north-east from the centre of the city. A nice row of shade-trees lined two sides of the enclosure and presented a pleasing contrast to the white tents.

Pastors Fulton and Hare with Brethren Fisher and Lemke, were the Union Conference labourers who attended the meeting. Pastors Piper, Imrie, and Smith, with Brethren Behrens, Harvey, Newbold, and other workers of the local conference, also attended and took part in the meetings.

The camp-meeting continued from March 3 to 15. The camp, consisting of eighty-three tents, was all in readiness for the opening, and the conference was called on Wednesday morning, March 4. A number of important questions were considered, financial reports passed, and plans for conference work introduced.

One of the many interesting features of the meeting was the reports given by the field workers, church-school teachers, canvassers, *Signs* and Bible workers. Good cheer was sounded all along the line.

The Sabbath-school offerings for the two Sabbaths amounted to £21. The attendance on the last Sabbath was 423.

Church membership stood at 469, an increase of thirty-eight for the year. At the close of the meeting a baptismal service was held, at which twenty-three were buried with the Lord in baptism.

One of the most interesting features was a meeting conducted in the interests of the young people's work. The programme, in which a number of workers and young people took part, was arranged by Sister Rule for the evening after the Sabbath.

The Sabbath morning services proved times of great refreshing to all. On both occasions a large number came forward to seek for a closer walk with God.

The missionary campaign meetings conducted by Brother Lemke proved helpful and interesting. A number of enthusiastic workers planned to attend the Canvassers' Institute following the meeting.

The cooking demonstrations and health studies given by Sisters Piper and Newbold were practical and much appreciated by both strangers and our own people.

School interests were considered, and a number of students planned to attend school during the coming year.

At the closing meeting on Sunday night, Pastor Fulton spoke to a large congregation on the "Rise and Progress of the Message." Earnest attention was given to the many interesting figures and statistics that pictured the world-wide features of the message.

Altogether it was a good meeting and fine weather conditions prevailed.

We experienced the blessing of the Lord all the way through.

R. HARE.

"'Tis only lovely thoughts can make a lovely face."

Monthly Summary of Australasian Canvassing Work

Victoria and Tasmania

FEBRUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Prophetic Waymarks—			
E. M. Jeffery	125	23	£17 4 0
C. A. W. McGowan ...	141	36	28 7 0
Great Controversy—			
A. Bullas	168	73	58 19 0
Miss F. Harker ...	94	24	16 13 0
H. Swain	118	38	27 4 0
Heralds of the Morning—			
G. H. Bartlett... ...	97	28	15 12 6
Miss Pascoe	39	5	2 14 6
Miss Clarke	32	24	12 8 6
Miss M. Armstrong ...	57	33	17 5 6
Miss D. Quodrill ...	75	19	10 3 6
J. W. Roper	107	32	17 19 0
O. G. Bassell	145	17	8 13 6
A. C. Whitehead ...	77	17	9 5 6
J. Collins	135	32	20 2 0
D. Abel	146	46	29 4 0
F. P. Ward	174	34	21 17 0
Miss Osborne	55	7	4 4 6
Miss E. White ...	37	6	2 19 0
Practical Guide to Health—			
R. A. Caldwell ...	29	6	5 12 6
Miss Griffiths ...		23	15 2 6
R. Anderson	20	25	27 5 0
F. W. Vicary	106	14	14 7 6
D. Abel		1	1 0 0
A. Davies	23	15	10 10 0
L. C. Faulkhead ...	17	4	2 10 0
F. Loyd	179	81	81 0 0
L. G. Selley	69	41	38 7 6
E. Silva	15	15	10 10 0
S. G. Tunk	21	10	9 5 0
Seer of Patmos—			
M. Wilson	47	32	15 17 6
Coming King—			
Miss N. Holgate ...	41	11	3 15 6
Helps sold by Agents ...			27 8 6
	2379	769	£584 7 6

New South Wales

FEBRUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Heralds of the Morning—			
L. W. N. Byrne ...	101	30	£17 0 6
C. H. Davis	86	57	31 10 6
Practical Guide to Health—			
J. T. Boyd	28	6	4 17 6
F. Masters	64	35	36 17 6
W. A. Wilton ...		8	9 17 6
A. M. Potter	137	25	21 5 0
C. E. Harlow	26	17	17 7 6
H. B. Wicks		5	5 15 0
R. M. Totenhofer ...		9	11 12 6
C. Scheffler		9	9 7 6
Desire of Ages—			
L. W. N. Byrne ...		1	1 0 0
H. M. Blunden ..	122	84	104 7 6
A. Mountain	137	55	47 7 6
Helps sold by Agents ...			5 14 0
	691	341	£324 0 0

Queensland

JANUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Practical Guide to Health—			
G. S. Joseph	150	39	£46 10 0
J. Tinworth	144	32	38 15 0
W. J. Joseph	142	26	31 5 0
Patriarchs and Prophets—			
A. T. Start	73	49	38 4 6
Desire of Ages—			
Mrs. K. M. Newley ...	120	22	18 5 0
Heralds of the Morning—			
E. C. Watts	101	20	12 3 0
Helps sold by Agents ..			3 6 0
	730	188	£188 8 6

FEBRUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Practical Guide to Health—			
A. E. Hodgkinson ...	26	6	£6 15 0
W. Joseph	104	15	17 5 0
G. S. Joseph ...	129	14	17 15 0
J. Tinworth	129	33	37 12 6
Desire of Ages—			
Mrs. K. M. Newley ...	145	30	24 7 6
Heralds of the Morning—			
E. C. Watts	121	20	13 3 6
F. F. Lee	71	15	10 6 0
Miss A. E. Lee ...	98	29	18 19 0
C. M. Lee	91	35	23 10 6
Patriarchs and Prophets—			
A. T. Start	170	117	83 10 6
Helps sold by Agents ...			8 10 0
	1086	313	£262 0 6

New Zealand

FEBRUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Heralds of the Morning—			
Miss F. Knowles ..	8	6	£3 18 0
W. Martin	116	11	7 2 6
C. J. Reynolds ...	13	19	13 9 0
F. Tackaberry	25	36	21 10 0
F. Grabb	40	10	8 2 6
H. Meyers	132	48	37 11 0
B. Waldrom	158	83	65 15 0
Practical Guide to Health—			
G. H. Edwards ...	22	11	10 2 6
T. W. Graham	28	23	26 15 0
J. Pascoe	76	22	22 0 0
Family Bible—			
B. Waldrom	...	1	1 15 0
Helps sold by Agents ...			1 8 6
	589	260	£319 9 0

West Australia

FEBRUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Practical Guide—			
F. H. Gall	50	47	£51 10 0
A. P. House	56	21	16 17 6
R. R. Gooding	51	39	31 17 6
Miss Scambler ...		1	12 6
Heralds of the Morning—			
Miss Forbes	43	11	5 13 6
Miss J. Scambler ..	72	7	3 7 6
Bible Readings—			
Miss Forbes		2	1 17 0
Prophetic Waymarks—			
E. V. Clark	100	18	13 9 6
F. H. Gall		1	12 6
Other Books—			10 6
Helps sold by Agents ...			8 10 6
Subscriptions to Periodicals			1 14 6
	381	138	£136 12 6

South Australia

FEBRUARY, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Practical Guide to Health—			
J. W. Parsons	159	39	£18 7 6
L. P. Wyatt	42	2	1 5 0
G. Backhaus	148	32	34 10 0
Mrs. Withers	16	10	6 12 6
Bible Readings—			
Mrs. E. Penniment ...	27	9	6 7 0
E. Penniment ...	73	15	10 8 6
R. L. Sibley	101	40	29 8 0
Miscellaneous ...			5 15 0
Helps sold by Agents ...			7 11 0
	566	148	£134 19 6

Totals for February, 1914

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
New South Wales ..	691	341	£324 0 0
New Zealand	589	260	219 9 0
Victoria and Tasmania ...	2379	769	584 7 6
South Australia	566	148	134 19 6
West Australia	381	138	136 12 6
Queensland (January) ...	730	188	188 8 6
Queensland...	1086	313	262 0 6
	6422	2157	£1849 17 6

The Sabbath-school Lessons: Their Value, and How to Study Them

(Concluded)

How to Study

We have noticed that some of our present-day Sabbath-school members wait until the class recitation before they study their lesson; then they try to find the texts and follow the lesson, but this takes up valuable time and causes delay to the recitation. Many others wait until Friday evening or Sabbath morning, and then hastily go through the lesson texts in order to get the main points of the lesson for the recitation. But what real, permanent blessing do they receive from such study? It is not *study* at all. We are *not* simply to study for the recitation, or for the approval of men, but we are to study to show ourselves approved of God; and nothing less than a *daily* study of the Word will gain that approval.

Let the first thing be a careful reading of the lesson text. This should be done carefully and without any reference to lesson helps. We should make sure that we have sufficiently mastered the text to be able to tell the story of the lesson in all its details. This is not so easy as you might think. Do not take it for

granted that you can do this until you have tried it. The next step should be to study the geography and chronology of the lesson, to become familiar with its conditions and surroundings, so we can understand the events recorded in their relation to the times in which they occurred. This will give intensity to all the events of which we learn, and will help to keep in mind the details of the lesson. To get this information we should have the best lesson helps obtainable.

Those who have received the greatest blessing from the study of the lessons are those who have followed the plan of beginning the study on Sabbath afternoon, and continuing the same in connection with the morning or evening worship throughout the week. It seems appropriate that we should study the Sabbath-school lessons in connection with our family worship, that we may ask God for the enlightenment of the Holy Spirit as the lesson is studied. The first time the lesson texts could be read over. Then each one could be assigned some portion of the lesson to present at worship at other times during the week,—one to give a synopsis; one to locate the places mentioned, if any; one to look up historical points in connection with the lesson, etc. In this way the study could be varied each time and the interest kept up, and at the end of each week the lesson would be learned from every standpoint.

In this connection, please allow me to quote the following paragraph: "Parents, set apart a little time each day for the study of the Sabbath-school lesson with your children. Give up the social visit, if need be, rather than give up the hour devoted to the precious lessons of sacred history. Parents as well as children will receive benefit from this study. Let the more important passages of Scripture connected with the lesson be committed to memory, not as a task, but as a privilege. Though at first the memory may be defective, it will gain strength by exercise, so that after a time you will delight thus to treasure up the precious words of truth. And the habit will prove a most valuable aid to religious growth."—"*Testimonies on Sabbath-school Work.*"

If the study of the lesson has been neglected, the first thought that comes to our minds on Sabbath morning, almost invariably, is: "I think I will not go to Sabbath-school to-day." Once the lesson is well learned, the inclination to be absent from the Sabbath-school will disappear, and instead there will be an irresistible desire on the part of each one to be in his or her place when the school is opened. I know this to be true from personal experience.

If both teachers and pupils have studied their lessons thoroughly, when the time for recitation comes there will be no need for lesson books from which to read the questions in a formal way, and open Bibles in the hands of members of the class from which to read the answers; but the Word will be stored in the mind, and all will be ready to give a reason for the hope that is within them.

When in a class recitation I see a teacher depending solely on the lesson pamphlet or paper, and the pupils constantly referring to the lesson texts, I can only conclude that both teacher and pupils are lame, and they are using the pamphlet, or lesson text, as a crutch. Crutches are all right in their place, and serve a very good purpose for those who must have them; but it is far better not to require them.

CONCLUSION

If you would be a Bible student, study the Sabbath-school lessons. If you would be a home missionary, bringing the message of salvation to your neighbours and friends, study the Sabbath-school lessons. If you would kindle a lively interest and zeal in the work of foreign missions, study the Sabbath-school lessons. If you would be led by the Holy Spirit into all truth and be filled with all the fullness of God, study the Sabbath-school lessons. If you ever get the impression that you are called to serve the cause of God in any capacity, and at the same time you have not been taking the trouble or interest to study the Sabbath-school lessons, you are mistaken in that impression. The Lord does not call those who are careless or indifferent to His service. Study the Sabbath-school lessons.

I make bold to say that it is my impression that the Sabbath-school has been the most powerful single agency in the work of this denomination to keep our people together and make the church what it is to-day; and the study of these lessons is the dynamo that has furnished the power.

Before closing this paper, dear members and teachers of the Sabbath-school, let me add one more word by way of appeal. Let us make up our minds that by the grace of God there shall be no more half-hearted study of the Sabbath-school lessons. Let us enter upon the study of these lessons as if we knew that in them we have eternal life. If we do this in the true spirit of devotion, we shall soon experience the quickening power and spiritual growth that we have waited for so long, and when our last lesson has been faithfully learned, we shall receive a diploma from the great Teacher that will give us an abundant entrance to the school above.

O. O. FORTNER.

EVERY year when the week of prayer comes around there is a great demand made by those who do not get the paper regularly, for the special number of the RECORD containing the readings. Would not the present time afford a good opportunity for our church elders, missionary secretaries, and others, to solicit the subscriptions of members in your church who do not take the paper. They will then be sure of getting the week-of-prayer number as well as the regular visits of the paper thereafter.

Obituary

LIVAI DAME.—It becomes our sad duty to chronicle the death of another of our faithful native fellow-workers in this field, which took place at Navai, Colo, on Friday, February 20, 1914. Though just a young man, who had spent only about two and a half years in the field work, Livai, (Levi) proved himself to be a most faithful and devoted worker, and his decease makes another break in our corps of native workers. Livai accepted present truth when just a lad, and immediately entered the Buresala School, where he spent a number of years. He was a frequent sufferer from tropical rheumatism, which, apparently, was the cause of his death. A week or two before he died, he had a very definite impression that the end was near, and at once went to the elder of the church in a village some miles distant, with whom he remained until the end came. He told the brethren a few days before not to weep for him, for his "eternal rest" was sure. During his life he was often heard to repeat the text, "Be thou faithful unto death, and I will give thee a crown of life." The funeral service was conducted by Ratu Kelevi, the elder of the Lewa-Navai church, where Livai had laboured for the past year.

A. G. STEWART.

Australasian Record

THE OFFICIAL ORGAN OF THE

AUSTRALASIAN UNION CONFERENCE OF SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS

"Mizpah," Wahroonga, N.S.W., Australia

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WHEN your copy of the RECORD comes in a red wrapper, it indicates that your subscription is expiring, and that your renewal is kindly solicited. Please order promptly, that no copies may be missed.

THREE of the patients of the Sydney Sanitarium have taken their stand for the truth recently.

THE good news comes from Auckland that ten have taken their stand for the truth there, all but one of these having stepped out since the recent camp-meeting in Palmerston.

A MAN who is reading "Great Controversy" delivered to him by a colporteur in New Zealand, writes for a catalogue of our publications and some tracts on our doctrines, particularly on the Sabbath question.

BROTHER and Sister Carswell arrived from New Zealand on Tuesday, March 24, and will be located at the Avondale Health Retreat while Brother Carswell engages in translating work for the Maoris.

PASTOR FULTON returned by the *Warilda* from the West on Friday, March 27, Brother Fisher arriving the Monday previous. They report an excellent camp-meeting, and a bright outlook for the work in the West Australian Conference for the year to come.

NURSE POWELL is doing good work in Sydney as a house-to-house medical missionary. She not only gains access to the homes through this means, but is finding many who are appreciative of the help she is able to give them. Brother Roy Thompson is also spending some time in this city in the same work with good success.

AGAIN we call attention to the coming week of prayer. When this paper reaches the outposts of our territory, this season will be close at hand, May 2 to 9 being the date fixed. That all may have the excellent matter contained in the readings for the meetings, the special RECORD, in which they are printed, has already been posted to our mission fields.

THE annual report of the British and Foreign Bible Society continues to show wonderful progress. A year ago the issues for the first time exceeded 7,000,000. Last year the total rose to 7,899,562. Ten new versions have been added, making the number of languages now 450. In China a total of 1,868,000 Scriptures has been issued. During the Balkan war 150,000 Testaments and Gospels were distributed among the soldiers. Since the society began operations in 1804, the total output has been over 244,000,000 copies of the Scriptures.

More News from Pitcairn

WE have been greatly favoured of late in receiving so many communications from Pitcairn Island, and all of such an encouraging nature. The following letter from Brother and Sister Adams was written on January 30, and reached our office on March 13:

Just a few lines to let you know how we are getting on. We are now holding our camp-meeting and it is proving a precious season to our souls. The Lord is coming graciously near to us and is stirring up the hearts of His people, reclaiming those who had given up, and deepening the experience of those desiring a closer walk with God. We are praying that the work will not be a superficial one, but that it will be lasting. The people are beginning to realize the nearness of Christ's soon coming and the need of a preparation to meet Him.

We conduct three general meetings each day for the adults, one for the young people, and one for the children. We commence our early morning meeting at five o'clock, and are reading from the Spirit of Prophecy on the second advent and the necessary preparation for that event. Our midday meeting is held at one o'clock, and we are reading on the responsibility of parents to their children, home training, and health reform. The evening meeting is held at 6 p.m., and takes the form of Bible studies. "Importance of Studying God's Word," "Repentance," "Conversion," "The Holy Spirit," "What It Means to be a Christian," "Living Up to the Light," are some of the subjects presented. The season will close on Tuesday. May God bless it to the good of every soul, is our prayer.

Sister Adams and the baby are doing well. I trust that the Lord's blessing is with you all. We do long for some news from you and our loved ones, but we are strong and of good courage in the Lord. We have only one desire, and that is to glorify God and be used of Him in the salvation of precious souls. God bless you is our prayer.

Three days after the receipt of the foregoing letter, another came to hand, dated February 3. From this we quote the following:

We finished up our camp season yesterday, and it was a season of refreshing to both old and young. The Lord came near by His Holy Spirit and touched and softened hearts. Especially were the young affected, and many came forward with tears and repentance. Confessions were made of wrongs that have existed for thirty years. Public wrongs were made right. In fact, there was real searching of heart, the desire of all being to have their records clear in the books of heaven. I believe that in most cases the work was genuine.

I do pray that God will give us wisdom and grace that we may be able to look after the members here and feed them with food that will be convenient for them, that they may grow up to the full stature of men and women in Christ, and at last stand perfected before Him. Remember us before the throne of grace.

"THE largest share of the annoyances of life, its daily corroding cares, its heartaches, its irritation, is the result of a temper uncontrolled. . . . By putting on the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, ninety-nine out of a hundred of the troubles which so terribly imbitter life, might be saved."

Something Worth While

A MOST attractive little booklet in colours, setting forth the object of the Sydney Sanitarium, and giving other information such as all contemplating coming to the institution would like to know, and such as would awaken an interest in the minds of those who have never before heard of it, is now ready for circulation. The booklet contains many fine views of both the interior and the exterior of the institution, and is by far the finest thing of the kind yet published. Who will help to place it in the hands of the hundreds of people who might be induced thereby to come to the sanitarium? Copies of this booklet can be obtained from any of our health food agencies, or through your State Tract Society.